

PROCESSES

A process is born from repetition, not from the urge to control.

When to build, when to simplify and when to let it die.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

With no repetition, it is bureaucracy in advance.

THE CASCADE

How useless bureaucracy is born.



WHAT YOU SEE

Something serious happened once...



THE MECHANISM

...so three approvals are created for never again...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the team pays a toll forever, over a single case.

A process built in a panic tends to be out of proportion to the real risk.

THE FORK

A process earns its place like this.

WHEN IT EARNs IT

01

— ☐ The decision repeats and always ends the same? Build it.

02

— ☐ The error is expensive and recurring? Build the minimum.

03

— ☒ Does it exist only for the internal audit record? Kill it.

A good process hands time back. If it only consumes, it became a toll.

THE METHOD

The process traffic light.

01 **GREEN, BUILD IT**

a repeated decision, an expensive error, or new people all the time

02 **AMBER, SIMPLIFY IT**

it exists, it solves something, but nobody can follow it fully

03 **RED, KILL IT**

nobody uses it, nobody understands it, or it is just for the record

Run your area's processes through this light. Most will not stay green.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four lines are enough to start.

01 • GREEN,
BUILD IT

What it is for.

the problem it solves, in one sentence the team recognizes

02 • AMBER,
SIMPLIFY IT

Who decides what.

a name and a ceiling, not the name of a whole department

03 • RED, KILL
IT

The steps that cannot be skipped.

three or four, the rest is personal preference in disguise

04

When it does not apply.

the written exception stops people bypassing it in the dark

TWO MODELS

A process that organizes or one that imprisons.

THE COMMON MODEL

Imprisons

Born from the fear of erring again

Grows with every exception

Serves to transfer blame

Nobody can explain it from memory

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Organizes

Born from observed repetition

Shrinks as the practice improves

Serves to release decisions

Fits on one page and everyone knows it

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three symptoms of bureaucracy.

01 An approval nobody has ever rejected.

- if everything passed for two years, that is a stamp, not a control.

02 A document only the author has read.

- a process nobody practices does not exist, it is filed fiction.

03 A rule nobody can explain the reason for.

- it usually solved a problem that does not exist anymore.

Killing a dead process is management work too, and almost nobody does it.

THE CHAIN

The new hire test.

01

Hand the process to someone who started this week.



02

She cannot run it on her own?



03

Then there is no process, there is oral tradition.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Oral tradition scales until the first absence, and falls with it.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

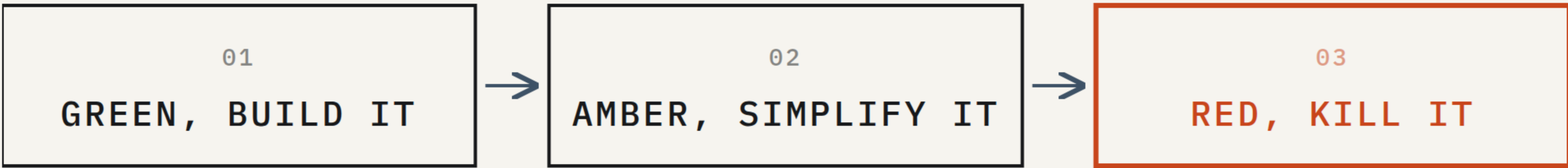
One hour to clear the path.

▣ STEP 01 List the decisions you repeated in the last month. the ones showing up three times or more go into the green	▣ STEP 02 Pick one heavy process and cut it in half. start with the approvals that have never rejected anything	■ STEP 03 Kill one process and tell the team it is over. announcing the death matters as much as announcing the birth
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A good process frees decisions. A bad one pushes accountability upward.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Process Traffic Light, in the order that matters.



A process exists to organize, never to imprison.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
next time you think about building a process.

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